

THE BATTLE IS IN THE MIND

TEXT: Ephesians 6:10-18 (NKJV) *"Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord and in the power of His might.11 Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.12 For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places.13 Therefore take up the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.14 Stand therefore, having girded your waist with truth, having put on the breastplate of righteousness,15 and having shod your feet with the preparation of the gospel of peace;16 above all, taking the shield of faith with which you will be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked one.17 And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God;18 praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, being watchful to this end with all perseverance and supplication for all the saints. "* Ephesians 6:10-18 (LB) *"Last of all I want to remind you that your strength must come from the Lord's mighty power within you. 11 Put on all of*

God's armor so that you will be able to stand safe against all strategies and tricks of Satan. 12 For we are not fighting against people made of flesh and blood, but against persons without bodies—the evil rulers of the unseen world, those mighty satanic beings and great evil princes of darkness who rule this world; and against huge numbers of wicked spirits in the spirit world. 13 So use every piece of God's armor to resist the enemy whenever he attacks, and when it is all over, you will still be standing up. 14 But to do this, you will need the strong belt of truth and the breastplate of God's approval. 15 Wear shoes that are able to speed you on as you preach the Good News of peace with God. 16 In every battle you will need faith as your shield to stop the fiery arrows aimed at you by Satan. 17 And you will need the helmet of salvation and the sword of the Spirit—which is the Word of God. 18 Pray all the time. Ask God for anything in line with the Holy Spirit's wishes. Plead with him, reminding him of your needs, and keep praying earnestly for all Christians everywhere."

INTRO: God said [Genesis 1:26-28](#) (NKJV)
"Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness; let them have dominion over the

fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over the cattle, over all the earth and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth.”²⁷ So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them.²⁸ Then God blessed them, and God said to them, “Be fruitful and multiply; fill the earth and subdue it; have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over every living thing that moves on the earth.”

The make-up of man: (Put up Power point - Body, Soul, and Spirit)

- Body
- Soul
- Spirit

The body is our earth suit - It is temporal not eternal. In the body we have our senses - see, feel, taste, touch, hear, and smell.

The soul is our mind, will, and emotions. The soul is part of the mental realm - emotions, intellect, feelings, inhibitions, personality, and reasoning.

The spirit is the God conscious part of man. This is the part of us that is capable of knowing

God and developing a relationship with him. It is through our spirits that God speaks to us - It is in our spirit that we worship God.

A true description of the way you are; would be: You are a spirit, you have a soul, and you live in a body.

When you die the body goes back to the ground but the soul and spirit lives on for an eternal day! If that be the case, what should we spend the most time working on?

I. THE STRUGGLE...

The warfare is this - The body and the soul is teamed up against the spirit!

The Bible is filled from beginning to end with examples and warnings of the warfare that we are facing.

Every person in this place, me included, is struggling with something tonight...

- Dishonesty
- Disobeying
- Cursing
- Lusting
- Habits

II. THE ARMOR & WEAPONS...

If we are in a war we should not be on the field of battle without proper clothing...

The whole armor of God...

- Helmet of salvation...
- Breastplate of righteousness...
- The girdle of truth...
- Feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace...

The weapons...

- The shield of faith...
- The sword of the Spirit...

2 Corinthians 10:3-6 (NKJV) *"For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war according to the flesh.⁴ For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds,⁵ casting down arguments and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ,⁶ and being ready to punish all disobedience when your obedience is fulfilled."*

III. THE VICTORY OR LOSS...

What factors decide the outcome of the war within?

- Who gets the most attention?
- Who are you feeding the most?
- Who gets the most exercise?

(Story of 2000 pound gorilla)

The difference between victory and defeat is what you have done before the day of battle!